

Emergency and inheritance guide

What to do if I can no longer act

My estate includes digital funds. They are not held at a bank and cannot be claimed through a court. Only whoever holds the matching words can access them. So that these words cannot be lost or stolen from a single place, I have split them and placed the parts in several locations. This guide walks you through the recovery.

Take your time. Waiting costs nothing.

As long as the shares are spread out, no one can move the funds, not even you.
There is no reason to rush and no reason to show the words to strangers.

How to proceed

1 Get an overview

There is a custody overview. It lists which wallets exist, which of them are split, and at which places the envelopes are kept.

It is kept: _____

2 Collect the envelopes

A split wallet needs a minimum number of shares, usually three of five. Fewer is not enough, more does no harm. Do not open the envelopes until you have all the ones you need, and work in a place where you are undisturbed.

3 Combine the shares

At seedhodler.io, ideally on a computer with no network connection. Enter the words of the shares there. The result is a sequence of 12 or 24 words, the seed itself.

4 Check the result

Every form carries a check address. Restore the wallet and compare its first receiving address with it. If the two do not match, the result is wrong, even if it looks perfectly valid. In that case move nothing and get help.

5 Get access

Enter the 12 or 24 words into a new hardware wallet. If the wallet has a passphrase, you also need it. Where it is kept is written on the wallet profile.

If seedhodler.io no longer exists

The split follows the open SLIP-0039 standard. Any library that implements it combines the shares. Watch the last step: there the result is not a seed but the BIP-39 entropy. It still has to be turned back into a BIP-39 mnemonic. A technically skilled person needs about an hour.

Wallets that are not split

Not every wallet is split. For the rest, the full seed sits at a single place. Which ones these are is written in the custody overview. For them steps 2 and 3 fall away, and the words are entered directly.

What you must never do

Four mistakes that cannot be undone

1. Entering the words of a share into a hardware wallet. The device accepts them without an error and opens a different, empty wallet. The mistake surfaces only later.
2. Photographing the words, typing them, putting them in a cloud, or into a chat window. Not even briefly and not just to check.
3. Letting anyone push you to hurry, whoever it is.
4. Bringing all envelopes together in one place for good. That removes the protection.

Terms

Seed	12 or 24 words. Whoever has them has the funds.
Share	20 or 33 words. A fragment of a seed, worthless on its own.
Threshold	how many shares are needed, for example 3 of 5.
Passphrase	an extra, self-chosen word. Without it the same seed opens a different, empty wallet.
Check address	the wallet's first receiving address. The proof that the recovery is correct.

Who can help with the technical side

Name

Reachable at

Relationship / how known

Notes by hand

Place, date, signature